MEMPHIS
COMPUTER SUPPORT
WHATEVER YOU NEED | WHEREVER YOU ARE

The Cyber Security Crisis

NEW And Critical Changes To IT Security, Insurance Coverage And Data Protection Laws That Will Put Your Business **At Serious Financial Risk If Not Addressed This Year**

Discover what the vast majority of CEOs don't know and haven't been told by their IT company or team about changes to cyber security risks, insurance and growing data protection laws that put them at **UNDERAPPRECIATED RISK** of a crippling cyber-attack and subsequent costs, lawsuits and fines – and what to do about it now.

Provided By: Memphis Computer Support, LLC
Author: Melanie Suria
5865 Ridgeway Center Parkway
Suite 300 Memphis, TN 38120
(901) 496-8949

Notice: This publication is intended to provide accurate and authoritative information in regard to the subject matter covered. However, no warranties are made. It is provided with the understanding that the author and the publisher are NOT engaged in rendering legal, accounting or related professional services or advice and that this publication contains opinions of its author. This publication is NOT intended as a substitute for specific legal or accounting advice for any particular institution or individual. The publisher accepts NO responsibility or liability for any individual's decisions or actions made as a result of information or opinion contained herein.

About The Author

Melanie Suria is the Founder & CEO of Memphis Computer Support, LLC.
Her passion for IT began as an intern with the City of Memphis while attending the University of Memphis at the Herff College of Engineering to get her Bachelor's in Electronic Engineering Technology.
Then a couple of years later she was hired as an IT specialist to a floor of researchers and scientists providing the necessary IT support to over 200 users and devices at Memphis' own St Jude Children's Research Hospital. It was bittersweet to leave St Jude, but she decided to be at home to raise a family. However, the strong passion to help others and the continuous following she acquired after leaving St. Jude allowed her to form a small business by a complete accident in the Fall of 2010. Melanie has been helping businesses thrive with technology and best security practices for over 14 years.

Some of Our Trusted & Recognized Certifications

Tennessee Uniform Certification Program

Member Agencies

Tennessee Department of Transportation
Metropolitan Knoxville Airport Authority
Chattanooga Metropolitan Airport Authority
Memphis Shelby County Airport Authority
Metropolitan Nashville Airport Authority
Chattanooga Area Regional Transportation Authority
Memphis Area Transit Authority
Jackson Transit Authority
Smyrna Airport Authority
Tri-Cities Airport Commission
Clarksville Transit System
Regional Transportation Authority [Middle TN]
Nashville Metropolitan Transit Authority
Knoxville Area Transit
Jackson Airport Authority
Johnson City Transit
Bristol Tennessee Transit
Murfreesboro Rover Public Transit
Kingsport Area Transit Service

Tennessee Uniform Certification Program

Be It Known That
Memphis Computer Support LLC
Memphis, TN

Is certified as a Disadvantaged Business Enterprise through the

Tennessee Uniform Certification Program (TNUCP)

This Certificate represents that the company named above has been determined to be a minority and/or women-owned business pursuant to 49 CFR Part 23 and 26.

This certification is subject to suspension or revocation, and is renewable annually upon the issuance date. Third parties should contact the TNUCP directly to confirm the status of this certification.

Issuance Date: 12/30/2024

This certificate relates to DBE status and is not certification of expertise in any particular trade or field.

MATA

TNUCP member Agency

Anthony D. Amos
MATA Member Signature

BOARD OF COMMISSIONERS OF SHELBY COUNTY
OFFICE OF EQUAL OPPORTUNITY COMPLIANCE

October 24, 2024

MELANIE SURIA
Memphis Computer Support, LLC DBA Memphis Computer Support

Dear MELANIE SURIA:

The Shelby County Government Equal Opportunity Compliance (EOC) Office has received and processed your application for Locally Owned Small Business (LOSB) for recertification. After extensive review it has been determined that your company has met the criteria and complies with the applicable ordinance(s) governing the specialty certification for which you are approved.

The following specialty certification numbers(s) has/have been issued for all projects. LOSB-VC-1126-34343.

NOTE: Current specialty certification number(s) must be displayed on the outside of each bid envelope. You are required to pass an annual review to maintain each specialty certification.

Sincerely,

Shepperson A Wilbun Jr.
Administrator
Equal Opportunity Compliance

The Truth Nobody Is Telling You About
IT Security And The Risk You're Exposed To

All of the hard work, investments and time you've put into growing your business is at HIGH risk due to the false information and half-truths you've been told by high-paid IT companies and your insurance provider.

You think your **IT company** or person has your network protected. You think you're compliant with a growing number of new data protection and IT security laws (or at least good enough, close enough to being compliant and secure). You think your insurance company will cover your losses and expenses if a breach occurs and your business is significantly impacted. You think your staff is being smart and not putting you at risk because they "know" not to be stupid or click on strange e-mails. You think your bank, credit card processing company or software vendor assumes all the risk for the payments you take and the credit card processing. And you think that because you're small, nobody wants to target you.

Worst of all, you think a data breach would be minor inconvenience with very few negative effects or costs. **And two years ago, you might have been right...**

But today, ALL of these assumptions are wildly inaccurate – and if you're still operating on any of these, you are putting your business at risk of serious financial damages with long-reaching negative implications. Consider this report your wake-up call. There have been significant changes over the last few years in the impact of cyber-attacks, new regulatory compliance law about what YOU as a business owner are responsible for, what insurance will cover (and what's necessary to make sure your claim is not denied) and IT protections.

With all the changes, I can assure you of this: **the plan you put in place a year or two ago to deal with IT security and risk is no longer viable.**

We can practically guarantee that what you've been told about keeping your business secure from hackers is either wildly inaccurate or insufficient and incomplete, putting you in a position of underappreciated risk, and when a breach happens, those who sold you their "IT compliant" solution or IT security services will be nowhere to be found, accepting no responsibility, **leaving you to face it all on your own and paying out of your pocket.**

You don't want to be blindsided by a cyber-attack and then discover how much this can negatively impact you, then say, **"Why wasn't I told THAT?"**

To be clear, this is not just about meeting government standards around HIPAA, GLBA, PCI compliance, etc. This is about making sure you completely understand the risks associated with a cyber-attack, IT failure or employee mistake and the costs, consequences and damage that will result for your business.

That's why we wrote this report. Over the last few years, we've discovered that ZERO of the businesses and medical entities we've assessed before becoming clients are even close to being prepared for a security incident, much less able to pass a compliance audit.

Not a single one

All of them were operating under the incorrect assumption that they were "secure enough," and they grossly underestimated the costs and wide-reaching negative impact a breach would incur. Their trusted team of "experts," who are supposed to be informing them and protecting them, are FAILING to do their job. You are very likely in the same situation.

This means if you were to experience a breach **(and it's getting more and more likely you will),** your staff would instantly be hit with a crushing workload of cleanup to recover from the breach, dealing with auditors, the FBI and attorneys who will overwhelm you with things they need. You would also be financially devastated by the fines, emergency IT services, legal fees and services you would be forced to buy just to get back up and running.

Worse yet, there is a very good chance your insurance claim could be denied or not fully paid out due to your failure to do the things we've outlined in this report.

This is NOT a subject you want to take lightly or "assume" you have handled. IT compliance and IT systems security should NOT be entirely abdicated to your business administrator, IT department or company. It should not be assumed that because your software company is "HIPAA compliant" or hosted on an online portal that you are – and that you are protected from a cyber-attack. YOU need to get the facts about what it means to be "willfully neglectful" and make choices about what risks you are willing to take, if any, because it will be your business's reputation and your financial responsibility should a breach happen.

Bottom line: small businesses the #1 target for cybercriminals for reasons we'll discuss in this report – and you have almost certainly NOT been given a plan that is 1) complete, 2) practical, and 3) affordable. Your parachute is full of holes, and you are completely without a backup chute that will deploy.

QUESTION: When was the last time your current IT company had THIS conversation with you? What HAVE they told you about these new threats? If they have been silent, then I would urge you to read this report in full and act on the information urgently.